



restaurant

DROPOUT

SPRING RECIPES 2025



THIS WEEK'S MENU

Falafel Bowls with Lemon Dill Pilaf

falafel, lemon dill rice pilaf, romaine, tomatoes, cucumber, tzatziki, crazy feta, pickled jalapeños & shallots

Summer Orzo Salad with Seared Salmon

orzo, cherry tomatoes, cucumbers, herbs, herby lemon vinaigrette, seared salmon, lemon

Mediterranean Salad with Dilly Chicken Skewers

romaine, pita chips, cucumber, radish, herbs, crazy feta, herby lemon vinaigrette, falafel, dill-marinated chicken

Mediterranean-style Loaded Potatoes with Grilled Steak

grilled steak, baked potatoes, tzatziki, feta, dill, pickled jalapeños & shallots

Golden Chicken & Rice Pilaf (inspired by Chicken Tagine)

rice pilaf, caramelized shallots, chicken, spice blend, cherry tomatoes, feta, tzatziki



GROCERY LIST

Produce

- Shallots (4)¹³⁴⁵
- Garlic (7 cloves)¹²³⁴⁵
- Russet Potatoes (2 medium)⁴
- Lemons (4)¹²³
- Cherry Tomatoes (10 oz)¹²³⁵
- English Cucumbers (2)¹²³⁴⁵
- Radish (1 bunch)¹²³
- Romaine (2 hearts)¹³
- Parsley (1 bunch)¹²³⁵
- Cilantro (1 bunch)¹³
- Dill (1-2 large bunches)¹²³⁴⁵
- Jalapeños (4)¹³⁴

Shelf-Stable Goods

- Dry Garbanzo Beans (1 cup)¹³
- Long-Grain Rice (1 cup)¹⁵
- Orzo (1 ¼ cups)¹²⁵
- Pita Chips (7.33 oz)¹³

Eggs & Dairy

- Greek Yogurt (1 ¾ cups)¹³⁴⁵

Cheese

- Feta in Brine (8 oz)¹²³⁴⁵

Suggested Proteins

- 2 large (8-9 oz) Boneless Skinless Chicken Breasts³⁵
- 2 (12 oz) NY Strip Steaks⁴
- 2 (4-6 oz) Salmon Fillets²

KEY

- ¹ = Falafel Bowls
- ² = Summer Orzo Salad
- ³ = Mediterranean Salad
- ⁴ = Loaded Potatoes with Steak
- ⁵ = Golden Chicken & Rice Pilaf
- *=rollover ingredient



ESSENTIALS

& TIME SAVERS

Essentials

Fats

- Olive Oil¹²³⁴⁵
- Neutral Oil¹²³⁴
- Salted Butter¹²⁵

Acids & Vinegars

- Distilled White Vinegar¹³⁴⁵
- Red Wine Vinegar¹²³⁴

Spices & Aromatics

- Black Pepper²⁴
- Cayenne Pepper¹³
- Chicken Bouillon¹⁵
- Ground Cumin¹³⁵
- Dried Oregano²³
- Turmeric⁵

Other

- Kosher Salt¹²³⁴⁵
- Baking Soda¹³
- Baking Powder¹³
- White Cane Sugar¹³⁴
- Honey²³
- Dijon Mustard²³

Tools

- 2 (8-inch) Wooden or Metal Skewers³

Time Savers

Produce

- Shredded Romaine

Pantry

- Pickled Jalapeños
 - Jalapenos (-2 ½)
 - Shallot (-1)

Refrigerated

- Tzatziki
 - Garlic (-1)
 - Cucumber (-½ grated)
 - Greek Yogurt (- 1 cup)

Frozen

- Falafel
 - Garbanzo Beans
 - Shallot (-1)
 - Garlic (-2)
 - Baking Soda
 - Baking Powder
 - Cayenne Pepper

KEY

¹ = Falafel Bowls

² = Summer Orzo Salad

³ = Mediterranean Salad

⁴ = Loaded Potatoes with Steak

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Red = Subtract if using Time Saver



PREP LIST



KEY

- ¹ = Falafel Bowls
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= used in "prepped ingredient"

Green = keep out during prep

8-24 HOURS BEFORE PREPPING

- ☐ Soak 1 cup of Garbanzo Beans in 2 cups water + 1 tsp Baking Soda

PREP DAY

- ☐ Preheat oven to 400°F
- ☐ Prep Produce
 - Cucumber (2; peel & deseed | 1; chop half moons¹³ | 1/2; finely dice² | 1/2; grate)
 - Radish (wash, dry, thinly slice)²³
 - Romaine (wash, dry, & thinly chop)¹³
 - Lemon (1; peel [w/ a vegetable peeler] | 1; zest)
 - Herbs
 - Cilantro (1 bunch; chop)³
 - Parsley (1 bunch; chop)²³⁵
 - Dill (1-2 bunches; roughly chop)²³⁴⁵
 - Jalapeños (1; roughly chop | 2 1/2; thinly slice | 1/2; left whole)
 - Shallot (1; roughly chop | 2; thinly slice (divided)⁵ | 1: dice)
 - Garlic (5 cloves; peel | 2 cloves; leave peels on)
- ☐ Prepare Potatoes (2; lightly brush with olive oil and season with a small pinch of salt. Pierce all over with a fork and bake for 60-65 minutes [or until soft])⁴

CLEANING BREAK

- ☐ Crumble Feta²⁴⁵
- ☐ Start Crazy Feta (see PDF 'Crazy Feta')¹³
- ☐ Prepare Falafel (see PDF 'Falafel')¹³
- ☐ Prepare Pickled Jalapeños & Shallots (see PDF 'Pickled Jalapeños & Shallots')¹⁴
- ☐ Prepare Sauces
 - Tzatziki (see PDF 'Tzatziki')¹⁴⁵
 - Herby Lemon Vinaigrette (see PDF 'Herby Lemon Vinaigrette')²³
 - Spicy Dill Marinade (see PDF 'Spicy Dill Marinade')³
 - Finish Crazy Feta (see PDF 'Crazy Feta')¹³
- ☐ Prepare Lemon Dill Rice Pilaf¹
- ☐ Caramelize 1/2 of the thinly sliced shallots (see Substack notes & Prep Demo)⁵
- ☐ Prepare Summer Orzo Salad Base (see PDF 'Summer Orzo Salad Base')²

OPTIONAL ADDITIONAL PREP

- ☐ Chicken Breasts (2 large; diced into 1 1/2 to 2-inch cubes [store breasts separately])³⁵
 - Store proteins in airtight bags in the freezer; The night before intended use, transfer to the refrigerator to thaw overnight



FALAFEL BOWLS

WITH LEMON DILL PILAF

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

Falafel (Page 6)¹³

Lemon Dill Pilaf (Page 7)¹

Tzatziki (Page 11)^{14s}

Crazy Feta (Page 10)¹³

Pickled Jalapeños & Shallots (Page 12)¹⁴

6 (or 1/2 batch) Falafel

1 batch Lemon Dill Pilaf, reheated

Thinly sliced Romaine Lettuce, *to taste*

4 oz (about 1/2 cup) Cherry Tomatoes, halved

1/2 Cucumber, chopped into half moons

Tzatziki, *to taste*

Crazy Feta, *to taste*

Pickled Jalapeños & Shallots, *for garnish*

Pita Chips (optional)

Instructions

Reheat the Falafel

1. Preheat your oven to 375°F.
2. Place cooked **falafel** on a sheet tray and bake for 6-7 minutes (or until fully reheated).

Construct the Bowls

1. Place 3/4 cup of reheated **lemon dill pilaf** at the base of each bowl.
2. Top each bowl with a handful of **romaine lettuce**, **cherry tomatoes**, and **cucumbers**.
3. Add a spoonful of **tzatziki** and **crazy feta**. Top with reheated falafel, **pickled jalapeños & shallots**, and **pita chips** (optional) and serve.

SUMMER ORZO SALAD WITH SEARED SALMON

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

Summer Orzo Salad Base (Page 8)²

Herby Lemon Vinaigrette (Page 13)²³

Summer Orzo Salad

1 batch of Summer Orzo Salad Base

2 oz (about ⅓ cup) Cherry Tomatoes, halved

½ Cucumber, finely diced

½ cup (35 g) thinly sliced Radish

⅓ cup (45 g) crumbled Feta

Herby Lemon Vinaigrette, *to taste*

A pinch chopped Parsley

A pinch chopped Dill

Seared Salmon

Neutral Oil

2 Salmon Fillets, seasoned with salt & pepper

1 Tbsp (14 g) Salted Butter

Juice of ½ a Lemon

Chopped Dill, *to taste*

Instructions

Finish Summer Orzo Salad

1. Combine **orzo base**, **tomatoes**, **cucumber**, **radish**, **feta**, additional **vinaigrette** (to your liking), and a pinch each of chopped **parsley** and **dill**. Season with another pinch of salt and stir until everything is well combined.

Prepare Salmon & Serve

1. Heat a thin layer of **neutral oil** in a large pan or cast-iron skillet on high heat.
2. Once the oil is hot and shimmering, add **salmon fillets** (presentation side down).
3. Sear for 3-4 minutes without touching the fillets.
4. Carefully flip the salmon, add **butter**, turn the heat down to low, squeeze the juice of ½ a **lemon** over each fillet, and add a pinch of **chopped dill**.
5. Using a spoon, baste the salmon with the melted butter in the pan and finish cooking for an additional 2-3 minutes, or until the salmon is cooked to your desired doneness.
6. Plate on top or alongside the **summer orzo salad** and serve.

MEDITERRANEAN SALAD WITH DILLY CHICKEN SKEWERS

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients



Spicy Dill Yogurt Marinade (Page 9)³

Falafel (Page 6)¹³

Crazy Feta (Page 10)¹³

Herby Lemon Vinaigrette (Page 13)²³

Dilly Chicken Skewers

1 large (8-9 oz) Chicken Breast, diced into 1 ½ to 2-inch cubes

Kosher Salt

1 batch Spicy Dill Yogurt Marinade

2 Wooden or Metal Skewers

High Smoke Point Oil

Mediterranean Salad

Romaine Lettuce, thinly sliced

2 oz (about ⅓ cup) Cherry Tomatoes, halved

½ Cucumber, chopped into half moons

½ cup thinly sliced Radish

4-5 (or remaining) Falafel, reheated & quartered

1-2 Tbsp Crazy Feta

¾ cup Pita Chips, crushed

Herby Lemon Vinaigrette, *to taste*

Kosher Salt, *to taste*

Chopped Parsley, *to taste*

Chopped Dill, *to taste*

Chopped Cilantro, *to taste*

Instructions

At least 2 hrs before cooking - Marinade the Chicken

1. Place cubed **chicken breast** in a mixing bowl with a generous pinch of **salt** and stir. Add the **dill yogurt marinade** and stir until the chicken is fully coated. Cover and refrigerate for at least 2 hours.

Prepare Chicken Skewers

1. Assemble chicken on your preference of **skewers** (wooden or metal).
2. **IF GRILLING (OUTDOORS):** Preheat your grill to 400°F and lightly grease with a **high smoke point oil**. Place chicken skewers on the grill and cook for around 9-10 minutes, flipping occasionally. Finish cooking chicken skewers on the grill covered (for another 7-8 minutes) or until the largest piece of chicken reaches 165°F internally.
3. **IF SEARING (INDOORS):** Preheat your oven to 400°F and then preheat a cast-iron skillet on the stove on high heat. Lightly grease with a **high smoke point oil**. Place skewers on the cast iron skillet and cook for around 9-10 minutes, flipping occasionally. Transfer chicken skewers to a sheet tray and finish cooking them in the oven for 7-8 minutes, or until the largest piece of chicken reaches 165°F internally).
4. Transfer chicken skewers to a plate, cover with foil, and allow them to rest for 5 minutes before serving.

Prepare Mediterranean Salad

1. In a large mixing bowl, add **romaine, tomatoes, cucumbers, radish, reheated falafel, crazy feta, and crushed pita chips**.
2. Add **herby lemon vinaigrette** and a pinch of **salt, parsley, dill, and cilantro**. Stir until well combined.
3. Plate and serve alongside chicken skewers.

MEDITERRANEAN-STYLE LOADED POTATOES WITH GRILLED STEAK

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

Tzatziki (Page 11)^{14s}

Pickled Jalapeños & Shallots (Page 12)¹⁴

Grilled Steak

2 (12 oz) NY Strip Steaks

High Smoke Point Oil

Kosher Salt

Freshly Cracked Black Pepper

Loaded Potatoes

2 baked Russet Potatoes

Tzatziki, *to taste*

Crumbled Feta, *to taste*

Chopped Dill, *to taste*

Pickled Jalapeños & Shallots, *for garnish*

Instructions

Bring Steaks to Room Temperature

1. About 20-30 minutes before cooking, lightly brush **steaks** with a **high smoke point oil** and generously season on both sides with **kosher salt** and freshly **cracked black pepper**.
2. Allow steak to sit for at least 20 minutes before cooking.

Reheat Potatoes & Sear Steak

1. Preheat your grill to 425°F.
2. Individually wrap pre-baked **potatoes** in foil and place on the grill. Cook for 12-15 minutes, flipping halfway

Hot Tip: You can also stick your pre-baked potatoes in the microwave for 1 ½ to 2 minutes to reheat.

3. Place the **seasoned steak** on the grill and cook for 4-5 minutes, or until slightly charred. Flip and continue cooking for 3-5 minutes (depending on how you like your steak done). 4 minutes (or 130°F-135°F) will result in a medium-rare, 6-7 minutes (or 140°F-145°F) will result in medium, and 8-9 minutes (or 150°F-155°F) will result in medium-well.
4. Transfer the grilled steak to a plate, cover loosely with foil, and rest for 5-10 minutes before slicing.
5. Slice into the potatoes, lengthwise, and top with **tzatziki, feta, dill, and pickled jalapeños & shallots**. Serve alongside the finished steak.

GOLDEN CHICKEN & RICE PILAF

(INSPIRED BY CHICKEN TAGINE)

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

Caramelized Shallots⁵

Tzatziki (Page 11)¹⁴⁵

Golden Chicken

1 large (8-9 oz) Chicken Breast, cut into 1 ½ to 2-inch cubes

Kosher Salt

1 tsp (3 g) Turmeric

½ tsp (1 g) Ground Cumin

Olive Oil

Rice Pilaf

1 Tbsp (14 g) Salted Butter

¼ cup (55 g) Orzo

½ cup (110 g) Long-Grain Rice

1 batch Caramelized Shallots

1 ¾ cups (425 g) Water

1 tsp (4 g) Chicken Bouillon

2 oz (or remaining) Cherry Tomatoes, halved

Crumbled Feta, *to taste*

Chopped Dill, *to taste*

Chopped Parsley, *to taste*

Tzatziki, *for serving*

Instructions

Prepare Golden Chicken

1. In a small mixing bowl, combine cubed **chicken**, a generous pinch of **salt**, **turmeric**, and **cumin**. Mix until the chicken is fully coated in spices.
2. Heat a thin layer of **olive oil** in a Dutch oven, large skillet, or frying pan (with a lid) on high heat. Once hot, add chicken.
3. Cook the chicken until a golden crust forms. Flip and cook for an additional 1-2 minutes. Transfer the par-cooked chicken to a plate and set aside.

Prepare Rice Pilaf

1. In the same pan, add **butter**. Once the butter is fully melted, add **orzo** and **rice**. Cook until the orzo is golden brown. Add **caramelized shallots** and stir until well combined.
2. Add **water** and **chicken bouillon** and bring to a boil. Once the water comes to a rolling boil, stir, add the par-cooked chicken, cover, and reduce the heat to low.
3. Simmer for 30-32 minutes.
4. After 30-32 minutes, turn off the heat and leave, covered, for an additional 5-10 minutes.
5. Before serving, top with **tomatoes**, **feta**, **dill**, and **parsley**, and serve with a dollop of **tzatziki**.

FALAFEL

Makes about 12-13 falafel patties

Ingredients

1 cup (200 g) Dry Garbanzo Beans
2 cups Water
1 tsp (6 g) Baking Soda
2 cloves of Garlic (10 g)
¼ cup (14 g) thinly sliced Radish
1 Tbsp (10 g) Red Wine Vinegar
Juice of ½ a Lemon (20 g)
2 tsp (7 g) Kosher Salt
¼ cup (12 g) chopped Cilantro
¼ cup (12 g) chopped Parsley
¼ tsp (<1 g) ground Cayenne
½ tsp (<1 g) ground Cumin
1 ½ tsp (4 g) Baking Powder
1 small Shallot (30 g), diced
Neutral, High Smoke Point Oil, *for cooking*

Instructions

8-24 hrs before Prep - Soak Garbanzo Beans

1. Place **garbanzo beans**, **water**, and **baking soda** in a large bowl and cover. Soak for at least 8 hours (or overnight) on the counter.

Prepare Falafel

1. Rinse garbanzo beans and drain well.
2. Add **garlic**, **radish**, **red wine vinegar**, **lemon juice**, and **salt** to a blender and blend until fully combined. Set aside.
3. In a food processor, combine the soaked and drained **garbanzo beans**, **cilantro**, **parsley**, **cayenne**, **cumin**, **baking powder**, and **shallot**. Pulse until the garbanzo beans are ground. Transfer to a large mixing bowl.

Hot Tip: Be sure to really process your garbanzo beans or your falafels might fall apart.

4. Using your hands (or a rubber spatula), mix in the blended wet ingredients.
5. Once fully mixed, use a large spoon or cookie scooper to scoop out 2 to 2 1/2-inch rounds of falafel. Allow falafel to rest for 15 minutes (uncovered).
6. In a skillet, heat a thin layer of **neutral oil** (*enough to skillet fry*).
7. Using your hands, shape falafel rounds into patties/disks (*lightly oil your hands to avoid sticking*).
8. Once the oil reaches 350°F, add falafel patties. Fry for 3 to 4 minutes, flipping halfway. Transfer to a paper towel-lined plate and season with salt.

To Store: Transfer to an airtight container and store in the refrigerator for later use.

How to Reheat the Falafel

1. Preheat your oven to 375°F.
2. Place cooked **falafel** on a sheet tray and bake for 6-7 minutes (or until fully reheated).

LEMON DILL RICE PILAF

Makes about 1 ½ cups

Ingredients

1 Tbsp (10 g) Olive Oil
1 Tbsp (14 g) Salted Butter, *divided*
¼ cup (55 g) Orzo
½ cup (110 g) Long Grain Rice, rinsed & strained
1 ¾ cups (425 g) Water
A pinch of Kosher Salt
1 tsp (3 g) Chicken Bouillon
Peel of 1 Lemon*
1 Tbsp (4 g) chopped Dill

*To peel a lemon, use a vegetable peeler.

Instructions

1. Heat **olive oil** and ½ a **tablespoon of butter** (7 g) in a medium saucepan on medium heat.
2. Once butter is fully melted, add **orzo** and stir. Cook until the orzo is toasted and golden brown.
3. Stir in **rice**. Add **water, salt, chicken bouillon,** and **lemon peel**. Bring to a boil.
4. Once the water comes to a rolling boil, stir once, reduce the heat to low/simmer, cover with a lid, and cook for 18-20 minutes.
5. Remove the rice pilaf from the heat and let it rest (covered) for 10 minutes.
6. After 10 minutes, remove the lid, take out the lemon peels (you can discard them), and stir in **dill** and the **remaining ½ tablespoon of butter** (7g).

To Store: Place cooled-down rice pilaf in an air-tight container (within 2 hours of cooking) and store in the refrigerator.

SUMMER ORZO SALAD BASE

Makes roughly 2 cups

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

Herby Lemon Vinaigrette (Page 13)²³

$\frac{3}{4}$ cup Orzo, cooked & strained

$\frac{1}{4}$ cup (55 g) Herby Lemon Vinaigrette

Kosher Salt

Instructions

1. In a large bowl, combine cooked (and strained) **orzo**, **lemon vinaigrette**, and a pinch of **salt**. Stir.
2. Transfer to an air-tight container and refrigerate for at least 4 hours before assembling and serving.*

***Note:** Allowing the orzo to sit in the vinaigrette will enhance the overall taste of the pasta salad; however, to prevent the produce from prematurely spoiling, we'll be adding the remaining ingredients right before serving.

SPICY DILL MARINADE

Makes about 1 cup

Ingredients

$\frac{3}{4}$ cup (170 g) Greek Yogurt

Juice of 1 Lemon (38 g)

2 Tbsp (30 g) Olive Oil

1 Tbsp (20 g) Distilled White Vinegar

$\frac{1}{2}$ of a Jalapeño (17 g)

$\frac{1}{3}$ cup (13 g) chopped Dill

1 clove of Garlic (5 g)

1 tsp (3 g) Kosher Salt

$\frac{1}{4}$ tsp White Cane Sugar

Instructions

1. Blend **all ingredients** until smooth and fully combined.

To Store: Transfer to an airtight container and store it in the refrigerator for later use.

CRAZY FETA

Makes about $\frac{3}{4}$ cup

Ingredients

$\frac{1}{2}$ Shallot, cut into large dice
1 Jalapeño, cut into large rounds
2 cloves of Garlic (skin on)
Olive Oil
Kosher Salt
 $\frac{1}{2}$ of an 8 oz block of Feta (130 g)

Instructions

1. Preheat your oven to 400°F.
2. Place **garlic**, **shallot**, and **jalapeño** on a small sheet tray and lightly coat with a drizzle of **olive oil** and a pinch of **kosher salt**.
3. Bake for 15 minutes, or until the garlic, shallots, and jalapeños are soft. Allow everything to cool down for 15-20 minutes.
4. Add **feta**, roasted garlic (remove the peel), shallot, and jalapeños to a food processor and pulse until finely chopped and fully combined.

To Store: Transfer to an airtight container and store it in the refrigerator for later use.

TZATZIKI

Makes about 1 ½ cups

Ingredients

½ English Cucumber, deseeded, grated & pressed*

1 cup (230 g) Greek Yogurt

2 Tbsp (7 g) finely chopped Dill

1 Tbsp (7 g) Olive Oil

1 clove (5 g) Garlic, grated

1 tsp (4 g) White Vinegar

¾ tsp (3 g) Kosher Salt

***to press**, take 1-2 paper towels and gently press against the grated cucumber to extract excess moisture.

Instructions

1. In a small mixing bowl, stir **all ingredients** together until fully combined.

To Store: Transfer to an airtight container and store it in the refrigerator for later use.

PICKLED JALAPEÑOS & SHALLOTS

Makes about 1 ½ cups

Ingredients

2 ½ Jalapeños, thinly sliced
1 Shallot, thinly sliced
½ cup (112g) Water
¼ cup (60 g) White Cane Sugar
¼ cup (50 g) Red Wine Vinegar
1 tsp (3 g) Kosher Salt

Instructions

1. Place sliced **jalapeños** and **shallots** in a pint (2 cups) deli container.
2. In a saucepan over medium-high heat, combine **water, sugar, vinegar, and salt**.
3. Once the liquid begins steaming, remove from heat and pour directly over jalapeños and shallots.

To Store: Allow jalapeños and shallots to soften and come to room temperature before covering and storing in the refrigerator.

HERBY LEMON VINAIGRETTE

Makes about 1 cup

Ingredients

Zest of 1 Lemon (4 g)
Juice of 1 Lemon (35 g)
1 clove of Garlic (5 g)
½ cup (100 g) Olive Oil
¼ cup (55 g) Red Wine Vinegar
2 Tbsp (32 g) Honey
1 Tbsp (4 g) finely chopped Parsley
1 Tbsp (4 g) finely chopped Dill
1 tsp (7 g) Dijon Mustard
¾ tsp (4 g) Kosher Salt
½ tsp (1 g) Dried Oregano

Instructions

1. In a blender, add **all ingredients** and blend until fully emulsified.

To Store: Transfer to an airtight container and store it in the refrigerator for later use.